3,000 years in this land: the sources

3,000 שנה בארץ הזאת: המקורות

Thanks for asking! Here is where every number in the series comes from. Ancient population figures are scholarly estimates with wide ranges, so treat them as the best guesses of historians, not a census.

תודה ששאלתם! הנה המקורות לכל המספרים בסדרה. מספרי אוכלוסייה עתיקים הם הערכות של חוקרים, עם טווחים רחבים.

Part 1: Who lived in this land?

חלק 1: מי חי בארץ?

Population by community, 1200 BCE to today, between the Jordan and the sea (including the West Bank and Gaza).

- Magen Broshi, ancient population estimates of the land
- Sergio DellaPergola, Jewish demography (Hebrew University)
- Justin McCarthy, The Population of Palestine (Ottoman and Mandate records)
- British Mandate censuses, 1922 and 1931
- Israel Central Bureau of Statistics; Palestinian Central Bureau of Statistics

Part 2: Who ruled this land?

חלק 2: מי שלט בארץ?

Years each power ruled all or part of the land. Periods overlap, dates are rounded, and early monarchy dates are debated.

- Encyclopaedia Britannica: Palestine; Israel and Judah; Hasmonean dynasty; Mamluk; Ottoman Empire
- Michael Coogan (ed.), The Oxford History of the Biblical World; The Cambridge History of Judaism
- Encyclopaedia of Islam (caliphates, Ayyubids, Mamluks)
- Israel Finkelstein and Neil Asher Silberman, The Bible Unearthed (the early monarchy debate)

Part 3: Who lived in Jerusalem?

חלק 3: מי חי בירושלים?

- Ottoman tax registers 1525 to 1553 (Amnon Cohen and Bernard Lewis)
- Travellers and consuls: Seetzen 1806, Robinson 1838, Schultz 1844; British consular reports 1864 and 1874
- British censuses 1922 and 1931; Israel CBS (1967 census, 2011)
- Jerusalem Institute for Policy Research: end of 2024, 1,050,200 residents, 60% Jews and others, 40% Arabs

> **Honesty note:** counts from the 1840s to the 1870s disagree (Ottoman registers left out foreign Jews). In most counts from the 1860s on, Jews are the largest group in Jerusalem.

שאלה בשבילכם: איזה חלק הכי הפתיע אתכם? ענו לי בהודעה.

Sources

מקורות

1. Wikipedia, Demographic history of Jerusalem: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Demographic_history_of_Jerusalem
2. Jerusalem Institute for Policy Research, Statistical Yearbook: https://jerusaleminstitute.org.il/en/yearbook/
3. Encyclopaedia Britannica, Palestine: https://www.britannica.com/place/Palestine
4. Wikipedia, Hasmonean dynasty: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Hasmonean_dynasty